PHASE 1 - UNDERSTAND

Who gets useful guidance between retail and private banking?

- Mass-Affluent Wealth Advice - evidence-led readout from all 9 RBI Understand prompts
- RBI prompt run: Market | Competitors | Technology | Terminology | Stakeholders | Scope | Data sources | Analysis | Storytelling
- Source folder: docs/challenges/02-understand-rbi/

Our evidence today: useful, but not all equally strong

- Confirmed public = checked on official public pages.
- Reported = one internal expert view; External = another market/population; Mechanism = plausible pattern; Unknown = needs internal data.
- Rule: do not turn external benchmarks or AI outputs into RBI facts. No internal RBI data or customer interviews yet in this readout.

Mass affluent and Premium overlap - and advice offers already exist

- Mass affluent is a customer segment; Premium is a service tier. They overlap but are not the same thing.
- Regional pattern: adviser access, video/app contact, planning tools, thresholds based on income or savings.
- Gap to investigate: customers below thresholds, digital-to-human handover, after-investing follow-up, advice scope and price clarity.

Where customers may get stuck in the current journey

- Working journey: Trigger -> Information -> App/branch -> Questionnaire -> Proposal -> Signing -> Funding -> Review.
- Possible pains: wrong timing, jargon, repeated information, paperwork, unclear fit, friction, funding drop-off, weak follow-up.
- Understand question: where does a specific mass-affluent customer become uncertain, stop, repeat information, or need human help?

04 - REPORTED INSIGHT

Advisor capacity may be part of the problem - but we have only one internal view

- Reported themes: limited branch time, paperwork, complex tools, education needs and assisted digital service.
- Measure next: session time, preparation vs meeting vs paperwork, clients per adviser, tool usage, points where customers ask for a human.
- Do not generalise the Serbian expert interview to every RBI market.

External benchmarks create urgency - not proof of an RBI problem

- 8.6%: UK adults receiving investment/pension advice in the prior 12 months - external benchmark.
- 29%: wealth clients saying they may change their primary provider within 3 years - external intention, not churn.
- RBI advice reach, drop-off, retention and adviser time remain unknown and need internal data.

06 - MECHANISM TO TEST

A plausible risk is silent defection: the account stays, the investments leave

- Mechanism: interest in investing -> no timely/clear help -> invests elsewhere -> salary account stays -> bank loses wealth relevance.
- This is not measured at RBI.
- Test why customers use brokers, fintechs or state securities: price, ease, trust, advice quality, or something else?

Possible causes - and where technology may help without choosing the solution

- Customer/process: knowledge, confidence, jargon, suitability steps, goal clarity and follow-up.
- Channel/people: digital-to-human handover, adviser capacity, repeated data collection and human support at key moments.
- Technology: robo/hybrid and goal-based planning are mainstream; adviser GenAI is emerging; unsupervised AI advice is high risk.

One market, one customer group, full journey - then one stage to prototype

- Manage closely: mass-affluent customers, Premium bankers/advisers, affluent segment management.
- Keep satisfied early: Compliance/Legal, digital/app team and senior management.
- Proposed boundary to decide: one market, one main customer group, journey to first goal review, one painful stage to prototype.

09 - EXIT GATE

Understand is complete enough to move on when the team makes the key decisions

- Decide: market, mass-affluent subgroup, provisional problem area and top 2-3 painful journey stages.
- Request: segment size/share investing, journey drop-off, robo/automated-advice usage, adviser session/preparation time.
- Carry into Empathize: H1 personalisation, H2 knowledge/confidence, H3 digital+human preference, H4 adviser data/tools/time.